



restaurant

DROPOUT

SPRING RECIPES 2025



THIS WEEK'S MENU

White Fish Souvlaki with Tzatziki

white fish fillets, dried herbs, garlic, olive oil, lemon, tzatziki, finely chopped fresh herbs

Spring Vegetable Shakshuka with Warm Flatbread

tomato-red pepper simmer sauce, feta, eggs, arugula, tahini lemon dressing, sugar snap peas, fresh herbs, warm flatbread, extra-virgin olive oil

Peperonata Pizza with Feta & Egg

jammy peperonata medley (shallots, tomato, and bell pepper), extra-virgin olive oil, feta, freshly ground black pepper, eggs, finely chopped herbs

Tomato & Pepper-Braised Chicken with Lemon Dill Rice Pilaf

tomato & pepper braising sauce, feta, lemon dill rice pilaf, tzatziki, dill, chives, olive oil drizzle

Yogurt-Marinaded Chicken Skewers with Warm Flatbread

spiced yogurt marinade, boneless skinless chicken breast, arugula, tahini lemon dressing, radish, snap peas, finely chopped herbs, warm flatbread



GROCERY LIST

Produce

- Shallot (3)²³⁴
- Garlic (12 cloves)¹²³⁴⁵
- Lemon (4)¹²³⁴⁵
- Roma Tomatoes or On The Vine Red Tomatoes (2)²³⁴
- Sugar Snap Peas (8 oz)²⁵
- Persian Cucumber (1)¹³⁴⁵
- Bell Peppers (3 [Red, Yellow, or Orange])²³⁴
- Radish (1 bunch)¹²⁵
- Arugula (5 oz)¹²⁵
- Dill (1 large bunch)¹²³⁴⁵
- Chives (1 bunch)²³⁴
- Mint (~11-12 leaves)*

Shelf-Stable Goods

- Orzo (1/4 cup)¹⁴
- Long Grain Rice (3/4 cup)¹⁴
- Crushed Tomatoes (28 ounce can)²⁴
- Chicken Stock (1 cup)⁴

Eggs & Dairy

- Eggs (7-9)²³
- Greek Yogurt (2 2/3 cup)¹³⁴⁵

Cheese

- Feta (8 oz)²³⁴⁵

Suggested Proteins

- 2 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts⁴⁵
- 2 (4 oz) White Fish Fillets (Tilapia, Cod, or Halibut)¹

KEY

¹ = White Fish Souvlaki

² = Spring Veggie Shakshuka

³ = Peperonata Pizza

⁴ = Tomato & Pepper Chicken

⁵ = Chicken Skewers

*=rollover ingredient



ESSENTIALS

& TIME SAVERS

Essentials

Fats

- Olive Oil¹²³⁴⁵
- Salted Butter¹⁴

Spices & Aromatics

- Black Pepper¹²³⁴⁵
- Dried Oregano¹⁵
- Dried Thyme¹
- Dried Rosemary¹
- Paprika²⁴⁵
- Cumin²⁴⁵
- Cinnamon⁵
- Chicken Bouillon¹⁴
- Red Pepper Flakes²⁴

Other

- Kosher Salt¹²³⁴⁵
- Flaky Salt (optional)³
- All-Purpose Flour²³⁵
- Cornmeal³
- White Cane Sugar²³⁴⁵
- Active Dry Yeast²³⁵
- Honey¹²⁵
- Tahini¹²⁵

Tools

- 2 (8-inch) Wooden or Metal Skewers

Time Savers

Refrigerated

- Pre-Peeled Garlic
 - 1 bulb of Garlic
- Tzatziki
 - Persian Cucumber
 - 2 cups Full-Fat Greek Yogurt
 - 4 Garlic cloves
 - 1 Lemon

Frozen

- Cooked Rice
 - Long-Grain White Rice (3/4 cup)
- Pizza Dough (must also get Flatbread)
 - Active Dry Yeast
 - All-Purpose Flour
 - Cornmeal

Bakery

- Flatbread (must also get Pizza Dough)
 - Active Dry Yeast
 - All-Purpose Flour

KEY

- ¹ = White Fish Souvlaki
- ² = Spring Veggie Shakshuka
- ³ = Peperonata Pizza
- ⁴ = Tomato & Pepper Chicken
- ⁵ = Chicken Skewers

Red = Subtract if using Time Saver



PREP LIST

KEY

¹ = White Fish Souvlaki

² = Spring Veggie Shakshuka

³ = Peperonata Pizza

⁴ = Tomato & Pepper Chicken

⁵ = Chicken Skewers

 = used in "prepped ingredient"

 = estimated time

Green = keep out during prep

- Prepare Flatbread Dough (see PDF 'All-Purpose Flatbread Dough')²³⁵
- Prep Produce (⌚40-45 minutes)
 - Arugula (wash & dry and/or transfer to container with paper towel)¹²⁵
 - Sugar Snap Peas (8 oz; slice/chop at a diagonal)²⁵
 - Radish (1 bunch; cut into batons or thinly slice)¹²⁵
 - Bell Peppers (3; core & thinly slice)
 - Lemon (1; peel & slice in half | 2; slice in half)
 - Tomatoes (2; dice)
 - Persian Cucumber (1; grate into a clean towel)
 - Herbs
 - Dill (1 large bunch)¹²³⁴⁵
 - Chives (1 bunch)²³⁵
 - Garlic (12 cloves; peel)¹
 - Shallot (3; thinly slice)

CLEANING BREAK

- Finish Flatbread (see PDF 'All-Purpose Flatbread Dough')²³⁵
- Create Blanching Station (see Substack Note in 'Mise en Place')
- Prepare Peperonata Medley (see PDF 'Peperonata Medley')³ 
- Blanch Sugar Snap Peas²⁵
- Crumble Feta²³⁴⁵
- Prepare Lemon Dill Rice Pilaf (see PDF 'Lemon Dill Rice Pilaf')¹⁴
- Prepare Sauces (⌚35 minutes)
 - Tahini Lemon Dressing (see PDF 'Tahini Lemon Dressing')¹²⁵
 - Spiced Yogurt Marinade (see PDF 'Spiced Yogurt Marinade')⁵
 - Tzatziki (see PDF 'Scratch That Tzatziki')¹³⁴⁵
 - Tomato & Red Pepper Simmer Sauce (see PDF 'Tomato and Red Pepper Simmer Sauce')²⁴

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP

- Chicken Breasts (2 large; diced into 1 ½" pieces [store breasts separately])⁴⁵
 - Store proteins in airtight bags in the freezer; The night before intended use, transfer to the refrigerator to thaw overnight



WHITE FISH SOUVLAKI WITH TZATZIKI

ADAPTED FROM “SCRATCH THAT” BY ALIX TRAEGER

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Tahini Lemon Dressing (Page 11)^{12s}

Scratch That Tzatziki (Page 6)^{134s}

Lemon Dill Pilaf (Page 8)¹⁴

White Fish Souvlaki

¼ cup Olive Oil

Juice of ½ Lemon

2 cloves of Garlic, minced or grated

1 tsp Dried Oregano

½ tsp Dried Thyme*

½ tsp Dried Rosemary*

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

2 (4-ounce) White Fish Fillets, such as cod, halibut,
or tilapia, as even thickness as possible

*See note on Substack “Time To Shop!”

Accompaniments

1 oz (or 1 small handful) Arugula

A large pinch of Radish Batons

Tahini Lemon Dressing, *to taste*

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Mint, torn, *for garnish*

Chopped Dill, *for garnish*

Scratch That Tzatziki, *for serving*

½ batch Lemon Dill Pilaf, reheated

½ Lemon, sliced into wedges

Instructions

Marinate Fish Fish

1. In an 8- or 9-inch square dish, whisk together **olive oil, lemon juice, garlic, oregano, thyme,** and **rosemary** and season with **salt** and **pepper**. Taste and adjust the seasoning to your liking—it should be punchy!
2. Add the **fish** in a single layer and gently turn to coat evenly. Cover and marinate in the refrigerator for at least 30 minutes or up to 2 hours.

Cook the Fish & Serve

1. Position an oven rack about 6 inches from the broiler heat source and preheat the broiler. Line a baking sheet with aluminum foil and set a wire rack on top.
2. Remove the fish fillets from the marinade, allowing any excess to drip off, and transfer to the prepared pan. Broil for about 7 minutes for very thin fish like tilapia and up to 15 minutes for thick fish like cod, until the fish is cooked through and lightly charred on top, and flakes easily with a fork at its thickest point.
3. While the fish briefly cools, combine **arugula, radish, tahini lemon dressing,** and a small pinch of **salt** in a small mixing bowl and toss until well combined.
4. Plate the arugula, then use a spatula to carefully transfer the fish right on top. Sprinkle with **mint,** and **dill** and serve with the **tzatziki, lemon dill pilaf,** and **lemon wedges** on the side.

SPRING VEGETABLE SHAKSHUKA WITH WARM FLATBREAD

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Tomato & Red Pepper Simmer Sauce (Page 12)²⁴

Tahini Lemon Dressing (Page 11)¹²⁵

Flatbread Rounds [All-Purpose Flatbread Dough] (Page 9)²³⁵

Shakshuka

Olive Oil, *for cooking*

½ batch Tomato & Red Pepper Simmer Sauce

4-5 Eggs

¼ cup crumbled Feta, *plus more for garnish*

Spring Vegetable Salad

2 oz (or 1 large handful) Arugula

4 oz (or ½) sliced & blanched Sugar Snap Peas

A large pinch of Radish Batons

A pinch of chopped Chives, *plus more for garnish*

A pinch of chopped Dill, *plus more for garnish*

Tahini Lemon Dressing, *to taste*

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Accompaniments

2 Flatbread Rounds, reheated

Instructions

Make the Shakshuka

1. Heat **olive oil** in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Add the **tomato & red pepper simmer sauce**, and stir. Cook for 3-4 minutes, or until slightly bubbling. Stir again, then reduce the heat to medium-low.
2. Using the back of a spoon, create 4-5 divots in the sauce. Crack an **egg** in each divot. Cover the pan and allow the eggs to cook for around 5 minutes

Hot Tip: For a firmer yolk, cook for 7-8 minutes.

3. Remove the shakshuka from the heat and evenly sprinkle the **feta cheese** over the top. Cover and allow it to rest for 1-2 minutes.

Prepare the Spring Vegetable Salad & Serve

1. Before serving, combine **arugula, sugar snap peas, radish, chives, dill, tahini lemon dressing**, and a pinch of **salt** in a small mixing bowl.
2. Plate the shakshuka and right before serving, top with the arugula salad. Garnish with additional **feta, black pepper**, and additional chopped herbs, if needed. Serve alongside warmed **flatbread**.

PEPERONATA PIZZA

WITH FETA & EGGS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

All-Purpose Flatbread Dough (Page 9)^{23s}

Peperonata Medley (Page 7)³

Scratch That Tzatziki (Page 6)^{134s}

½ batch (or ~450g) All-Purpose Flatbread Dough

All-Purpose Flour, *for dusting*

Cornmeal, *for cooking*

½ batch (or remaining) Peperonata Medley

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

3-4 Eggs

½ cup crumbled Feta

A pinch of chopped Dill

A pinch of chopped Chives

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Flaky Salt, *for garnish* (optional)

¼ cup Scratch That Tzatziki, *for serving*

Instructions

Prepare the Pizza Dough

1. Remove the **all-purpose flatbread dough** from the refrigerator and allow it to rest at room temperature for 15 minutes.

Assemble & Cook the Pizza

1. Preheat your oven to 480°F.
2. On a **floured** surface, stretch the dough into a large round (about 12" in diameter) or rectangle. Transfer dough to a **cornmeal-dusted** or parchment-lined sheet tray.
3. Spread the **peperonata medley** evenly onto the dough, and sprinkle over a pinch of **salt**.
4. Using the back of a spoon, gently create 3-4 divots within the peperonata medley. Crack an **egg** onto each divot, then evenly sprinkle **feta** all over the pizza.
5. Bake for 12-13 minutes*, or until the crust is golden brown and the eggs are cooked. Remove from the oven and allow it to cool off for 3-4 minutes.
6. Before serving, garnish the pizza with **dill**, **chives**, **pepper**, and **flaky salt** (optional).. Serve with **tzatziki** on the side for dipping.

*Check on your pizza after about 10 minutes of baking. Depending on your oven size and strength, you might need to cook for longer (an additional 4-5 minutes) or pull it exactly at 12 minutes. The time will vary (check often).

TOMATO & PEPPER-BRAISED CHICKEN WITH LEMON DILL RICE PILAF

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Tomato and Red Pepper Simmer Sauce (Page 12)²⁴

Lemon Dill Rice Pilaf (Page 8)^{24s}

Scratch That Tzatziki (Page 6)^{14s}

Olive Oil

1 large Chicken Breast, 1 ½" diced

Kosher Salt

½ batch Tomato & Red Pepper Simmer Sauce

1 cup Chicken Stock

½ batch of Lemon Dill Rice Pilaf, reheated

¼ - ⅓ cup Crumbled Feta

Scratch That Tzatziki, *for serving*

A pinch of chopped Dill

A pinch of chopped Chives

Extra-Virgin Olive Oil, *for garnish* (optional)

Instructions

Braise the Chicken

1. Heat a small saucepan (or dutch oven) over high heat. Add a few glugs of **olive oil**, followed by **diced chicken**. Season with a generous pinch of **kosher salt**.
2. Sear chicken on both sides until lightly golden (around 2-3 minutes per side). Add **tomato & red pepper simmer sauce** and **chicken stock** and stir.

Hot Tip: Use the chicken stock to wash out the container of tomato & red pepper simmer sauce, to get every last drop!

3. Once the sauce begins to lightly boil, reduce the heat to low, cover with a lid, and let it cook for 30 minutes.
4. Remove the lid and cook for an additional 5-10 minutes, until the chicken breaks apart easily and the sauce has slightly thickened.
5. Turn off the heat and allow the chicken to cool slightly (around 5 minutes).

Assemble the Plate

1. Place reheated **lemon dill rice pilaf** in a shallow bowl, and plate the braised chicken on top or to the side. Top the braised chicken with a small handful of **crumbled feta**, a dollop of **tzatziki**, **dill**, and **chives**. Garnish with **extra-virgin olive oil**, if desired.

YOGURT-MARINATED CHICKEN SKEWERS WITH FLATBREAD

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Spiced Yogurt Marinade (Page 10)⁵

All-Purpose Flatbread (Page 9)^{23s}

Tahini Lemon Dressing (Page 11)^{12s}

Scratch That Tzatziki (Page 6)^{14s}

Chicken Skewers

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast, diced
into 1 to 1 ½" pieces

1 batch Spiced Yogurt Marinade

2 (8-inch) Wooden or Metal Skewers

Accompaniments

2 oz (or 1 large handful) of Arugula

¼ cup (or remaining) Radish Batons

4 oz (or ½) sliced & blanched Sugar Snap Peas

½ cup (or remaining) Crumbled Feta

A couple pinches of chopped Mint, *plus more for garnish*

A couple pinches of chopped Dill, *plus more for garnish*

Tahini Lemon Dressing, *to taste*

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

2 All-Purpose Flatbread Rounds, reheated

Scratch That Tzatziki, *for serving*

Instructions

Marinate Chicken

1. Pat the **chicken breast** dry with a paper towel and transfer it to a medium bowl. Cover the chicken with the **spiced yogurt marinade** and marinate it at room temperature for at least 30 minutes (or in the refrigerator for up to 8 hours).

Prepare the Chicken Skewers & Plate

1. Preheat your oven* to 450°F.
2. Assemble the **marinated chicken** on **skewers** (*about 8-9 pieces per skewer*).
3. Place the chicken skewers on a baking sheet topped with a wire rack and bake for 15-17 minutes, flipping halfway.
4. Switch your oven temperature/setting to broil and finish cooking the chicken skewers for 1-2 minutes until slightly charred and the internal temperature reaches 165°F.
5. Transfer the chicken skewers to a plate and allow them to rest for 5 minutes before serving.
6. In a small mixing bowl, combine **arugula, radish, snap peas, feta, mint, dill, tahini lemon dressing, salt, and pepper**. Stir until well combined.
7. Plate the **warm flatbread** and top with the tossed arugula salad. Place the skewers on top and garnish with **tzatziki**, additional herbs and **black pepper**.

*See substack note under A few quick notes

SCRATCH THAT TZATZIKI

ADAPTED FROM “SCRATCH THAT” BY ALIX TRAEGER

Makes about 2 cups

Ingredients

1 Persian Cucumber
2 cups Plain Full-Fat Greek Yogurt
4 cloves of Garlic, grated
Juice of 1 Lemon
2 Tbsp finely chopped Dill
Kosher Salt, *to taste*
Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Instructions

1. Grate the **cucumber** into a clean towel. Holding the towel over the sink, squeeze out as much liquid from the cucumber as you can.
2. Place the squeezed cucumber in a medium bowl and stir in the **yogurt**, **garlic**, **lemon juice**, and the **dill** to combine well.
3. Season the tzatziki with **salt** and **pepper** to your liking. Cover and refrigerate the tzatziki for at least 30 minutes or up to 24 hours before serving.

To Store: Transfer to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

PEPERONATA MEDLEY

Makes about 3 cups

Ingredients

1 Tbsp + ½ cup of Olive Oil
3 Shallots, thinly sliced
A couple of generous pinches of Kosher Salt
3 cloves of Garlic, grated
2 Roma Tomatoes, diced
3 Bell Peppers, thinly sliced

Instructions

1. Heat **1 tablespoon of olive oil** in a large pan over medium heat. Add **shallots** and a pinch of **salt** and saute for 3-4 minutes, until soft and translucent. Add **garlic** and sauté for an additional minute just until fragrant.
2. Add **tomatoes** and **bell peppers**, **½ cups of olive oil**, and another generous pinch of **salt**. Turn down the heat to low and cook for 30 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the peppers are completely soft and jammy.

To Store: Once completely cooled, transfer to an air-tight container and store in refrigerator for later use.

LEMON DILL PILAF

Makes about 3 cups

Ingredients

1 Tbsp (10 g) Olive Oil
1 Tbsp (14 g) Salted Butter, divided
¼ cup (55 g) Orzo
¾ cup (150 g) Long Grain Rice, rinsed and strained
2 cups (473 mL) Water
A pinch of Kosher Salt
1 tsp (3 g) Chicken Bouillon
Peel of 1 Lemon*
1 Tbsp (4 g) chopped Dill

*to peel a lemon, use a vegetable peeler

Instructions

1. Heat **olive oil** and a ½ **tablespoon of butter** in a medium saucepan on medium heat.
2. Once butter is fully melted, add **orzo** and stir. Cook until the orzo is toasted and golden brown.
3. Stir in rice and toast for 1 minute. Add **water, salt, chicken bouillon, and lemon peel**. Bring to a boil.
4. Once the water comes to a rolling boil, stir once, reduce the heat to low/simmer, cover with a lid, and cook for 18-20 minutes.
5. Remove the rice pilaf from the heat and let it rest (covered) for 10 minutes.
6. After 10 minutes, remove the lid, remove the lemon peels (you can discard them), and stir in **dill** and the remaining ½ **tablespoon** of butter. Season with additional salt, if needed.

To Store: Place cooled-down rice pilaf in an air-tight container (within 2 hours of cooking) and store in the refrigerator.

ALL-PURPOSE FLATBREAD DOUGH

Makes 1 medium (12") pizza and 4 (6 ½" to 7") flatbread rounds

Ingredients

1 ½ cups (318 g) Warm Water (100°F - 109°F)
1 Tbsp (15 g) White Cane Sugar
2 tsp (6 g) Active Dry Yeast
3 ½ cups (490 g) All-Purpose Flour
1 Tbsp (8 g) Kosher Salt
2 Tbsp (30 g) Olive Oil

Instructions

Make the All-Purpose Flatbread Dough

1. In a stand mixer fitted with a dough hook*, combine **water**, **sugar**, and **yeast**. Allow the mixture to sit for 3-5 minutes or until the yeast appears slightly foamy on the surface (after about 3-6 minutes).
2. Add **flour**, **salt**, and **olive oil**, and knead on low speed for 10-12 minutes. The dough should appear tacky and shiny.
3. Cover with plastic wrap and let it rise in a warm place for 1 ½ to 2 hours or until doubled in size.
4. Deflate and divide the dough in half (just under 450g each).

To Store: Place one round of dough in an airtight container and refrigerate for at least 24 hours (and up to 4 days).

Prepare the Flatbread Rounds

1. Divide the other dough half into 4 even rounds. Using a rolling pin, roll each ball of dough into a 6 ½" to 7" circle (they should be around ¼ -inch thick).
2. Heat a large cast-iron skillet over medium-high heat until it's just about to smoke. Place the flatbread on the skillet and cook for about 30 seconds to 1 minute. Flip and cook for an additional 1 minute, or until both sides are nicely browned. Cover the cooked flatbread round with a kitchen towel to prevent it from drying out and repeat with the remaining flatbread rounds.

To Store: Once the flatbread rounds are cooked and mostly cooled, transfer to a plastic baggie and store at room temperature or in the refrigerator.

*See Substack note in 'Mise en Place' if kneading by hand

SPICED-YOGURT MARINADE

Makes roughly 1 cup

Ingredients

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup (180 g) Greek Yogurt
Juice of 1 Lemon (40 g)
2 tsp (16 g) Honey
2 cloves of Garlic (7g to 9 g), grated
1 Tbsp (15 g) Olive Oil
2 tsp (7 g) Kosher Salt
1 tsp (2 g) Paprika
1 tsp (2 g) Oregano
1 tsp (2 g) Cumin
A pinch of Ground Cinnamon

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a mixing bowl and whisk until thoroughly combined.

To Store: Place the marinade in an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator.

TAHINI LEMON DRESSING

Makes about ½ cup

Ingredients

½ cup (95 g) Olive Oil
Juice of 1 Lemon (40 g)
2 Tbsp (28 g) Tahini
1 Tbsp (21 g) Honey
1 clove of Garlic (5 g)
½ tsp (2 g) Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. Place **all ingredients** in a blender and blend until emulsified and smooth.

To Store: Transfer the tahini lemon dressing to a squeeze bottle or an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use. Shake well before using, as it might separate in the refrigerator.

TOMATO & RED PEPPER SIMMER SAUCE

Makes 4 cups

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Peperonata Medley (Page 7)³

1 ½ cups (325 g) or ½ batch Peperonata Medley

1 ½ tsp (2 g) Ground Cumin

½ tsp (<1 g) Ground Paprika

½ tsp (<1 g) Crushed Red Pepper Flakes

1 (28 oz) can of Crushed Tomatoes

½ cup (135 g) Water

⅛ tsp or small pinch (<1 g) White Cane Sugar

1 ½ tsp (6 g) Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. Place the **peperonata medley** (excess oil included) in a large saucepan over medium-high heat. Once the peppers begin sizzling, around 1-2 minutes, add **cumin, paprika, and crushed red pepper flakes**, and cook for around 1 minute.
2. Once the spices are toasted, add **crushed tomatoes** and stir.
3. Add **water, sugar, and salt** and stir until well combined.
4. Reduce heat to a simmer and cook for 25-30 minutes.
5. Remove the sauce from the heat and allow it to cool. Taste and season with additional salt, if needed.

To Store: Once the sauce has cooled completely, place it in an airtight container and store in the refrigerator.